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Any aspect not expressly covered in this document will be resolved with a ruling by the Match Director

BRUTALITY MATCH RULES

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1. Range Safety - Intentional violation or flagrant disregard of these rules is subject to immediate disqualification and/or removal under Section 2.

1.1. Follow the four rules of firearms safety at all times:

- 1.1.1. Rule 1: Know and be able to justify the condition of your firearms at all times.
- 1.1.2. Rule 2: Keep your firearm pointed in a safe direction.
- 1.1.3. Rule 3: Keep your finger out of the trigger guard when not actively engaging targets.
- 1.1.4. Rule 4: Know your target, its background, and its foreground before engagement.

1.2. **Brutality Matches are run on Cold Ranges.** Unless under direct RO supervision and given the command to preload or load, every firearm must remain completely free of live ammunition or anything that may be mistaken by an RO for live ammunition (e.g. casings, snap caps, etc.). Subject to host facility restrictions, match staff are permitted to conceal or open carry loaded handguns on days they are not themselves competing.

1.3. **Chamber flags** are required to be used when transporting any firearm outside of a holster or case. A chamber flag must both hold the action open AND be clearly visible. A spent metal casing may not be used as a chamber flag.

- 1.3.1. While under RO supervision, chamber flags may be **temporarily** removed in order to facilitate pictures and/or video.

1.4. **Handling of firearms on the range will only occur in one of the following conditions:**

- 1.4.1. While under the direct supervision of an RO.
- 1.4.2. At a designated preloading or safety area, muzzle pointed directly into a berm.
- 1.4.3. Being safely carried to, from, and between stages:
 - 1.4.3.1. Long guns flagged or with manual actions open and carried or slung muzzle up or down without sweeping anyone. The use of bags, cases or carts are permitted unless otherwise specified.
 - 1.4.3.2. Handguns securely contained in a worn holster. Detachable holsters may be removed from or emplaced on a belt at a designated preloading or safety area so long as the handgun's barrel remains pointed in a safe direction.

1.5. **Firearms can be in three possible states while under RO supervision: RO-verified clear, Condition 3, or Loaded.**

1.5.1. **RO-verified clear firearms** are completely devoid of ammunition and detachable magazines. RO-verified clear firearms are treated as a stick not subject to sweeping violations, 180 violations, or a DQ if control is lost. A competitor and RO can set up an RO-verified clear firearm through one of the following procedures:

- 1.5.1.1. While making ready, the competitor pointedly does NOT load the firearm.
- 1.5.1.2. While making ready, the competitor shows clear for the RO.
- 1.5.1.3. During the stage, the competitor drops their detachable magazine and performs a clearing shot on a target.
- 1.5.1.4. During the stage, the competitor unloads and shows clear OR shoots their gun to empty and shows clear. Ideally, this will be communicated to the RO in advance.
- 1.5.1.5. It is the competitor's responsibility to ensure the RO is able to clearly see the empty magazine / magazine-well and empty chamber.
- 1.5.1.6. **The firearm is not considered RO-verified clear until the RO has verbally confirmed that it is clear.**

1.5.2. **Condition 3 firearms** have their action closed, their hammer or striker down on an empty chamber when possible, with a detachable magazine in the gun or ammunition in an integral magazine. Until loaded, Condition 3 firearms are treated as a stick not subject to sweeping violations, 180 violations, or a DQ if control is lost.

- 1.5.2.1. Detachable magazines and/or ammunition on external holders that cannot directly feed ammunition into the chamber (such as side saddles, match-savers, or stock/foregrip-mounted mag holders) do not make a weapon Condition 3.
- 1.5.2.2. A firearm may be brought to Condition 3 while making ready or preloading under RO supervision. The competitor must show clear, close the action, pull the trigger if doing so does not prevent loading of a magazine, load a magazine under RO supervision, and pointedly NOT chamber a round.
- 1.5.2.3. **Manual firearms** may be made Condition 3 during a stage by firing a shot and pointedly NOT cycling the action, leaving the hammer or striker down on a fired case.
- 1.5.2.4. **Semi-automatic firearms** may start a stage Condition 3 but CANNOT be made Condition 3 or returned to Condition 3 during a stage. Once a stage has begun, semi-auto firearms may only become Loaded or RO-verified clear.

1.5.3. **Loaded firearms** either have ammunition chambered or (as in the case of firearms that are being reloaded or remediated) are to be treated as though they have ammunition chambered for the sake of safety.

1.6. **Firearm transitions.** A competitor may not simultaneously handle two loaded firearms as defined above. In order to transition away from a firearm by slinging or holstering:

- 1.6.1. Manual firearms must be made either RO-verified clear or Condition 3 as provided above.
- 1.6.2. Semi-automatic firearms must be made RO-verified clear as provided above.
- 1.6.3. Where a dump box or table or other abandonment location is provided, firearms may be grounded in one of the following states:
 - 1.6.3.1. With all safety mechanisms activated, muzzle pointed in a designated safe direction.
 - 1.6.3.2. Condition 3.

- 1.6.3.3. RO-verified clear.
- 1.6.4. **Hot holstering a loaded handgun is not permitted. Hot holstering during a stage is subject to immediate disqualification under Section 2.** Due to its ubiquity in other disciplines, hot holstering during make ready will prompt a warning, but is not an immediate disqualification.
- 1.7. **Eye & Ear Protection**
 - 1.7.1. Eye protection must be worn by every individual (even non-competitors) at all times while on the range.
 - 1.7.2. Ear protection must be worn by every individual (even non-competitors) at all times while on or near a stage.
- 1.8. **Minimum target engagement distances:**
 - 1.8.1. For rifle calibers and shotgun slugs, no steel target shall be engaged at distances shorter than 50 yards.
 - 1.8.2. For pistol calibers, buckshot, and birdshot, no steel target shall be engaged at distances shorter than 10 yards.

2. Disqualifications

- 2.1. **If any RO or competitor witnesses a potential safety issue or disqualifying violation, they are to immediately yell the "STOP!" command.** If called by a competitor, they must explain to the RO what they witnessed.
- 2.2. **All potential disqualifications must be escalated to the Match Director** for confirmation with the RO(s) and the involved competitor.
 - 2.2.1. Confirmation discussions will be confined to the competitor, the RO(s), and the Match Director. If other competitors witnessed the potential violation, the Match Director may interview them.
 - 2.2.2. **Video evidence is encouraged** and welcomed in order to assist with confirming whether a disqualifying violation has occurred.
- 2.3. If the competitor has registered multiple runs in the same Brutality, a confirmed disqualification applies to the specific run in question and the competitor will not be permitted to shoot further that day.
 - 2.3.1. Additional runs on prior or subsequent days are not affected unless the Match Director determines the disqualifying violation to be particularly egregious.
 - 2.3.2. The Match Director may choose to allow the competitor to move additional runs on the same day to other shooting days to permit them to complete those entries.
- 2.4. **In addition to violations of Range Safety rules as described in Section 1, the following violations are subject to immediate disqualification and/or removal from the match:**
 - 2.4.1. **Accidental or negligent discharges**, including:
 - 2.4.1.1. Any shot that is clearly not aimed at a valid target.
 - 2.4.1.2. A shot which directly travels over a backstop / berm or in any other direction specified as unsafe, except that a shot legitimately fired at a target which then changes direction and travels in an unsafe direction is NOT a disqualifying violation.
 - 2.4.1.3. A shot which strikes the ground within 10 feet of the participant (or would have if not deflected or stopped by a prop), except when shooting at a target closer than 10 feet.

- 2.4.1.4. A shot that occurs while preloading, making ready or unloading a firearm.
- 2.4.1.5. A shot that occurs while reloading or fixing a malfunction.
- 2.4.1.6. A shot that occurs while picking up or setting down a firearm
- 2.4.1.7. A shot that occurs while changing hands or shoulders.
- 2.4.1.8. A shot that occurs while moving, unless intentionally shooting at targets on the move.
- 2.4.2. **Unsafe gun handling**, including the following examples and any other actions deemed unsafe by the Match Director:
 - 2.4.2.1. **Losing control of a Loaded firearm** - if this occurs, the RO must retrieve and clear the firearm (losing control of a Condition 3 or RO-verified clear firearm is not subject to disqualification, but incurs a +60 second penalty).
 - 2.4.2.2. Allowing the muzzle of a Loaded firearm to point uprange of the 180 or other designated muzzle-safe boundary (not applied to Condition 3 or RO-verified clear).
 - 2.4.2.3. Allowing the muzzle of a Loaded firearm to point at any part of the competitor's body during a course of fire (not applied to Condition 3 or RO-verified clear).
 - 2.4.2.4. Failing to keep the finger outside the trigger guard while not shooting after a "Finger!" warning from the RO (except when carefully de-cocking a firearm).
- 2.4.3. **Unsafe, unsportsmanlike, or rude conduct**, including the following examples and any other actions deemed unsafe or uncouth by the Match Director:
 - 2.4.3.1. Being intoxicated or under the influence of mentally or physically impairing substances while competing.
 - 2.4.3.2. Blatant unsportsmanlike conduct, attempts to cheat, or aggressive behavior (physical or verbal) towards any person.
 - 2.4.3.3. Refusal to contribute towards stage reset.
 - 2.4.3.4. Actions or displays intended to disrupt or offend other competitors and/or match staff.

3. Match Procedures & Scoring

- 3.1. A Zeroing Bay may be designated by match staff to be made available for zero confirmation and function-checking of firearms. Actions within a zeroing bay must be supervised by an RO. **If an RO is not present, the zeroing bay is closed.**
- 3.2. Competitors must be prepared to shoot in any conditions; stages will continue during appropriate light levels and will not delay for environmental considerations except due to unsafe circumstances such as lightning or severe weather.
- 3.3. **Brutality Matches use Time Plus scoring**; a competitor's time on each stage plus any penalties or bonuses determines their score, and a competitor's stage scores are totaled to produce their match score; the competitor with the lowest match score wins.
- 3.4. Each stage will have a written description, including its par time, bonuses, and penalties.
 - 3.4.1. The written stage description will be read to competitors as part of a stage brief along with any clarifications deemed necessary by the RO. Q&A time will be held after the reading of the written stage description.
 - 3.4.2. If conflicting instructions arise, **RO rulings overrule the written stage description**, the stage description overrules the division rulebook, and the division rulebook overrules the general match rules.
- 3.5. Unless otherwise stated by the stage brief, competitors will begin each stage as follows:

- 3.5.1. Standing at the start location, securely wearing all equipment.
- 3.5.2. First firearm Loaded held at low ready, all other firearms holstered or slung, Condition 3.
- 3.6. Competitors must complete the entirety of each stage within its par time.
 - 3.6.1. Failure to complete the stage within par or intentionally quitting a stage before completing the course of fire will result in the competitor receiving a score of the par time plus penalties for any missed targets and incomplete stage elements.
 - 3.6.2. Competitors are permitted to skip a required target (by informing the RO they are skipping the target) and accept the missed target penalty in order to complete the rest of the stage.
Competitors cannot make up skipped targets after leaving that shooting position.
- 3.7. Targets must be neutralized as follows:
 - 3.7.1. **Static targets** must be hit a required number of times. The RO will call "Hit," "Impact," or the number of hits observed to confirm neutralization.
 - 3.7.2. **Falling targets** must fall or otherwise move to the RO's satisfaction. If the RO observes three solid hits to the calibration zone, they will call that target neutralized.
 - 3.7.3. **Spinners** must be hit a required number of times OR must be completely rotated. The RO will call the number of hits observed or "Over," to confirm neutralization.
 - 3.7.4. **Paper or self-healing targets** will be scored per stage instructions.
 - 3.7.5. If an RO mistakenly calls a target neutralized, the competitor may choose to treat that target as neutralized and move on.
- 3.8. ROs will coach all competitors during the course of fire. **If a competitor does not wish to be coached, it is their responsibility to notify the RO during make ready.**
- 3.9. **Reshoots** will be granted (and the Match Director notified) for the following circumstances:
 - 3.9.1. RO error or interference.
 - 3.9.2. Safety concerns outside of the shooter's control.
 - 3.9.3. Prop or target failure beyond the ability to improvise a roughly-equivalent alternative.
 - 3.9.4. Timer failure that cannot be substituted with video evidence.
 - 3.9.5. Any other stage-ending failure outside the shooter's control or responsibility.
 - 3.9.6. Competitors may **request a mulligan** (reshoot for competitor's equipment failure) if they suffer a stage-ending malfunction prior to the final shooting position on a stage.
 - 3.9.6.1. **The Match Director must approve all mulligans.**
 - 3.9.6.2. Competitors may only use one mulligan in a division.
 - 3.9.6.3. Some divisions prohibit the use of mulligans.

4. General Firearms, Ammunition, & Equipment Rules

- 4.1. Competitors will declare one division at the beginning of each entry and adhere to that division's requirements for the entirety of that match entry. **See the division document (CQB or Mainline) for division requirements.**
 - 4.1.1. Competitors may purchase multiple entries to the same match in **different** divisions.
 - 4.1.2. Failing to adhere to division requirements will result in being moved into Outlaw division.
- 4.2. **All firearms used by competitors must be serviceable and safe**; if a firearm is declared unsafe by match staff, it must be withdrawn from the event until repaired to the satisfaction of the Match Director. If a competitor's firearm is safe but becomes unserviceable, they may request that the Match Director allow them to:

- 4.2.1. Repair their firearm with directly equivalent replacement parts.
- 4.2.2. Replace their firearm **once** in the division with a similarly configured substitute that still adheres to division requirements.
- 4.3. Competitors will use the same firearm(s) with no changes to major components (except for repairs and division exceptions) for the duration of their division at the match.
 - 4.3.1. Unless otherwise stipulated, all firearms will remain with the competitor (held, slung, or holstered) for the duration of each stage.
 - 4.3.2. **Firearms accessories** (sights, magnifiers, bipods, etc.) are governed by division rules.
 - 4.3.2.1. Unless otherwise stipulated, all accessories will remain attached to the firearm in the same location throughout the match and cannot be moved or removed. Swapping interchangeable shotgun chokes is permitted.
 - 4.3.2.2. Unless otherwise stipulated, handguns may not use braces or stocks.
 - 4.3.2.3. Flashlights and lasers are allowed, but must work as specified in their manual.
 - 4.3.3. The use of NFA full-auto is governed by the host facility. If they allow it, we allow it, though it probably will not be competitive.
 - 4.3.4. The use of Forced-Reset Triggers, Super-Safeties, Binary Triggers, and other "full auto we have at home" mechanisms is **not** permitted at Brutality Matches.
- 4.4. **Ammunition with tracer, incendiary, explosive, armor piercing, or steel/tungsten core (or other projectiles that may cause damage to targets or the range) are prohibited.**
 - 4.4.1. Bimetal projectiles (e.g. steel jacketed with a zinc or copper wash) are allowed.
 - 4.4.2. **Pistol ammunition** must be minimum .32ACP, maximum 10mm or .45LC, with a maximum velocity of 1600FPS (5.7mm polymer-tipped projectiles specifically are permitted to exceed this maximum), with 9x19mm Parabellum as the expected standard.
 - 4.4.3. **Rifle ammunition** must be minimum .30 carbine, maximum of a traditional battle rifle caliber (.308, 8mm Mauser, etc.), with 5.56x45mm NATO as the expected standard.
 - 4.4.4. **Shotgun loads** must be lead only, and **may be further governed by the host facility.**
 - 4.4.4.1. Shells must be minimum 20-gauge and 2.75 inch or larger.
 - 4.4.4.2. Birdshot must be #6 shot or smaller (#7, #7.5 #8, etc.).
 - 4.4.4.3. All shell types are limited to a maximum velocity of 1600FPS.
- 4.5. Unless otherwise stipulated, **a competitor will start each stage securely wearing their clothes and equipment to be used on all stages in the same configuration throughout the match** (e.g., if the competitor uses a backpack to fulfill their division requirements, they must securely wear the backpack at the start of each stage).
 - 4.5.1. Snivel gear, food, extra water/drinks, and extra ammunition are exempt from this rule.
- 4.6. Holsters must safely retain and protect their handguns during vigorous movement.
 - 4.6.1. **SERPA & "race" holsters are prohibited.**
 - 4.6.2. Holsters must cover the trigger unless using a single action revolver.
 - 4.6.3. Holsters must cover the slide of a semi-automatic handgun up to ½ an inch below the ejection port OR the cylinder of a revolver.
- 4.7. **Slings must remain attached to the firearm or attached to the competitor at all times.**
- 4.8. Anything used to protect a firearm from the elements during a stage must be carried or worn for the duration of the match.

See the division document (CQB or Mainline) for division requirements